Cross-Generational Texting, Office Subtext & Digital Punctuation Pragmatics (Vol. 6)

Why Punctuation, Corporate Euphemisms, and Group-Chat Hedging Diverge Across Generations (100% SFW, CC BY 4.0)

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All SlangLane Academic Working Papers & PDFs: https://slanglane.com/papers

Interactive ESL Teacher Kit & Quiz Maker: https://slanglane.com/esl

Abstract & Scope

Analyzes intergenerational texting friction (periods, trailing ellipses, emoji reactions), passive-aggressive corporate email formulas, and how younger speakers use hyperbolic slang (cooked, lowkey, bet, say less) as polite conversational alignment.

Interactive Companion Tools on SlangLane.com

Slang Age & Brain-Rot Diagnostic Lab: https://slanglane.com/vibe-check

Corporate Email <-> Gen Z Group-Chat Translator: https://slanglane.com/roast

Court & HR Legal Exhibit Stamp Generator: https://slanglane.com/exhibit

5x5 Classroom & Meeting Slang Bingo: https://slanglane.com/bingo

Side-by-Side Usage Comparisons (A vs. B): https://slanglane.com/compare

Indexed Thematic Entries (29 Headwords, Edition daily-2026-10-21)

1. banter (aliases: bants, bantering) - [Across the Atlantic | Playful relationship-dependent]

Playful, quick back-and-forth conversation, often involving teasing that the participants enjoy. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/banter

2. cheers - [Across the Atlantic | Friendly informal]

A toast when drinking; also informal "thanks" or a friendly sign-off, especially in British and Irish English. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cheers

3. chuffed (aliases: well chuffed, chuffed to bits) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal pleased]

Very pleased, proud, or delighted about something. "Chuffed to bits" is an especially enthusiastic version. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chuffed

4. craic (aliases: the craic, what's the craic, good craic) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal social]

Enjoyable company, conversation, fun, or news. "What's the craic?" can mean "what's happening?" or "how are things?" | Regions: IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/craic

5. eejit - [Across the Atlantic | pejorative]

A pejorative regional word for an idiot or fool, documented for Ireland and Scotland. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/eejit

6. FR (aliases: fr, frfr, for real, for real for real) - [Texting shorthand | Casual sincere or questioning]

"For real": an emphasis on sincerity, a strong agreement, or a surprised question meaning "seriously?" | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fr

7. FWIW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "FWIW": for what it's worth. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fwiw

8. ghosting (aliases: ghosted, ghost someone) - [People & relationships | Informal relationships and contact]

Ending or abandoning an ongoing connection by stopping communication without an explanation. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ghosting

9. gobsmacked - [Across the Atlantic | informal]

gobsmacked: utterly astonished and speechless. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gobsmacked

10. grand (aliases: that is grand, that's grand, I'm grand) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal reassuring]

In Irish English, often "fine," "okay," or "no problem." It does not necessarily mean magnificent or unusually impressive. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/grand

11. green flag (aliases: green flags, greenflag) - [People & relationships | Approving reassuring]

An encouraging sign that someone or something may be trustworthy, compatible, or worth pursuing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/green-flag

12. gutted - [Across the Atlantic | Informal deeply disappointed]

Very disappointed, upset, or crushed by an unwelcome result. Often used for a loss, cancellation, or missed opportunity. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gutted

13. ick (aliases: the ick) - [People & relationships | Informal aversion]

A feeling or expression of disgust or aversion. "The ick" can describe a reaction that makes someone suddenly feel put off. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ick

14. ICYMI - [Texting shorthand | internet slang]

ICYMI expands to 'in case you missed it,' introducing information for a reader who may have missed it. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/icymi

15. IDK - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IDK": I don't know. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/idk

16. IMO - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IMO": in my opinion. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/imo

17. IYKYK (aliases: if you know you know, iykyk) - [Texting shorthand | Knowing inside reference]

"If you know, you know": a signal that people with the shared experience or background will understand an unstated reference. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/iykyk

18. love bombing - [People & relationships | context-dependent]

love bombing: manipulative over affection tactic. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/love-bombing

19. mate (aliases: mates) - [Across the Atlantic | Familiar tone-sensitive]

A friend or a familiar way to address someone. It can sound warm, neutral, sarcastic, or confrontational depending on delivery. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mate

20. OMW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "OMW": on my way. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/omw

21. pookie - [People & relationships | Affectionate, cutesy or playful]

An affectionate name for a loved person, such as a partner, friend or relative; as an address, roughly sweetheart or darling. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pookie

22. POV (aliases: point of view, pov) - [Texting shorthand | Perspective scenario framing]

"Point of view." In captions, it usually introduces a situation the viewer is invited to imagine experiencing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pov

23. proper - [Across the Atlantic | colloquial]

A UK and Irish colloquial use of proper as an adverb meaning thoroughly or completely. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/proper

24. red flag (aliases: red flags, redflag) - [People & relationships | Warning sometimes exaggerated]

A warning sign that something may be wrong or deserves closer attention, especially in a relationship or decision. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/red-flag

25. situationship (aliases: situationships) - [People & relationships | Informal dating language]

A romantic connection whose status, expectations, or commitment have not been clearly defined. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/situationship

26. soft launch (aliases: soft-launch, soft launching, soft-launched) - [People & relationships | Social media indirect reveal]

Hinting at a romantic relationship online without clearly identifying the partner or explicitly announcing the relationship. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/soft-launch

27. sound (aliases: sound person, sound as) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal approving]

Decent, reliable, friendly, or good. As a short reply, "sound" can mean "okay," "agreed," or an appreciative acknowledgment. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sound

28. TBH - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "TBH": to be honest. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tbh

29. TL;DR (aliases: tl;dr, TLDR, tldr, too long didnt read, too long; didn't read) - [Texting shorthand | Concise sometimes dismissive]

"Too long; didn't read." It can dismiss a long message, but is also a common label for a short summary supplied by the writer. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tldr